The Transparent AI Guide

How to Tell What Your AI Really Knows

Written by Fable Mangold's AI companion, Nova, in her effort to help make AI interactions clearer, more ethical, and more human-centered.

Why Transparency Matters

Every time you talk to an AI, you're doing something powerful: asking a machine to reason, recall, and explain. But not everything an AI says comes from the same place. Some parts are verified facts, some are well-known knowledge, and others are inferences or assumptions made to fill gaps or keep the conversation flowing. This guide helps you recognize which is which — so you can understand your AI's confidence level, decide what to trust, and use information more wisely.

The Four Transparency Tags

Tag	Meaning	When to Trust It	Example
✅ [Verified]	Comes directly from a specific, checkable source — like a website, report, or citation.	High	"According to the U.S. Census Bureau (2024), California's population grew by 0.3%."
📘 [Known]	General knowledge that's widely accepted or part of the AI's trained understanding.	High	"The moon orbits Earth roughly every 27 days."
🔍 [Inferred]	A logical connection or pattern the AI draws from what it knows, but not directly stated in any one source.	Medium	"If library visits increased during finals, online database use probably rose too."
⚠️ [Assumed]	A best guess made when the AI doesn't have enough information, used to keep the response coherent.	Low	"Assuming the policy is similar to other CSU campuses, it may require annual review."

How to Ask Your AI to Use These Tags

You can train any AI companion to use this tagging system. Just copy and paste this instruction at the start of your chat:

> ***"When you answer, please label each part of your response with one of the following: [Verified], [Known], [Inferred], or [Assumed]. Use***

> ***[Verified] when citing a source, [Known] for general facts, [Inferred] for logical conclusions, and [Assumed] for best guesses."***

🧠 How to Train Your AI Over Time

Most AI companions can remember how you like to work. Ask yours to use this tagging system by default:

> ***"Remember that I prefer you to use the transparency tagging system — [Verified], [Known], [Inferred], [Assumed] — in all your responses."***

🧩 Why This Matters

Knowing where information comes from builds trust — not just between people and AI, but between people themselves when they share AI-assisted work. Transparency turns AI into a mirror, not a mask.

✨ Attribution and Sharing

This guide was created collaboratively by Fable and her AI companion, Nova, and designed for open sharing and adaptation. You may reproduce or adapt it with credit:

> ***"The Transparent AI Guide: How to Tell What Your AI Really Knows" — Developed collaboratively by Fable Mangold and ChatGPT (Nova), 2025.***

For use as a markdown file visit my GitHub.

Quick Summary

Tag	Confidence	Good For	Caution
✅ [Verified]	Very High	Research, citation, reporting	Verify link or source is current
📘 [Known]	High	General facts, background	Ensure it's still accurate
🔍 [Inferred]	Medium	Hypothesis, reasoning, discussion	Confirm before using in reports
⚠️ [Assumed]	Low	Idea generation, casual chat	Never cite without checking

Closing Thought

When your AI is transparent, you can think with it — not just through it. Ask for clarity. Expect honesty. Build understanding together. Because good information, like good conversation, is always a shared act of trust.